Rock Mix Glue

Sounds like: a finished rock record instead of separate tracks

ACCURACY B

Close enough to fool most ears.

NOT YET TESTED - settings are a starting point; trust your ears

WHAT YOU NEED (in this order)

`Master insert: MClass Equalizer -> MClass Compressor -> MClass Maximizer`

Starting material: a balanced rough mix hitting the master around -6 dB peaks

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DO THIS, STEP BY STEP

1. MClass Equalizer: Lo Cut ON (30 Hz rumble gone). Param 1: +1 dB at 100 Hz wide Q if the mix feels thin. Hi Shelf +1 dB at 10 kHz. That's it — master EQ is a nudge, not a fix.

2. MClass Compressor: ratio 2:1, attack SLOW (~35 ms so transients punch through), release fast or Adapt ON. Threshold until you see 1–2 dB reduction on the loud sections. Never more.

3. Listen with it bypassed vs in. The "in" version should feel slightly more like one performance. If it sounds squashed, back the threshold off.

4. MClass Maximizer: input gain until limiting shows 1–3 dB on peaks, Look Ahead ON, output -0.3 dB. Loudness comes from the mix, not this box.

5. A/B against a commercial rock reference at MATCHED volume (turn yours up/down till equal loudness) — louder always sounds "better" and lies to you.

Why this works

1–2 dB of slow-attack compression makes tracks rise and fall together — the "glue" is shared gain movement.

Why this order

EQ before comp: fix tonal balance first so the compressor reacts to the mix you want, not the mud you're about to cut.

Reason trick

Put the chain in the master section's insert slot (SSL master bus), not on a separate channel — it stays with the song file.

The skill you just learned

Glue compression: the compressor you barely hear working.

Worth buying?

For A: an SSL-style bus comp emulation (Softube, ~$99) adds the nonlinear character MClass lacks.